Digitization, TEI-Transcription, and Online Publication of the "Siete Partidas" with Gregorio López's Gloss (1555): Challenges and Progress in the "School of Salamanca" Project

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Introduction

The long-term project The School of Salamanca. A digital collection of sources and a dictionary of its juridical-political language is a collaboration between the Academy of Sciences and Literature | Mainz, the Max Planck Institute for Legal History and Legal Theory, Frankfurt a.M., and the Goethe-University Frankfurt a.M. Our growing digital collection plays an important role in the legal history research by offering a text-image reading view with full text, lemmatized search and various downloadable formats of central texts of the School of Salamanca as well as important reference works on which the Salmantine authors relied when writing their books during the 16th and 17th century.

Challenge

One of the most ambitious goals in our project has been the digital edition of the reference work *Las Siete Partidas* (López 1555/de Castilla 1221–1284). The complexity of this task lies in the unique nature of the print edition 1555, which contains two simultaneous works by different authors comprising seven volumes and approximately 1750 pages: the original Castilian text by Alfonso X (written 1221–1284) and the Latin gloss by Gregorio López published 1555. Moreover, the structural layout of this dual-text edition presents significant challenges for its transcription and digital representation. In our poster, we will present our workflow to address this challenge.

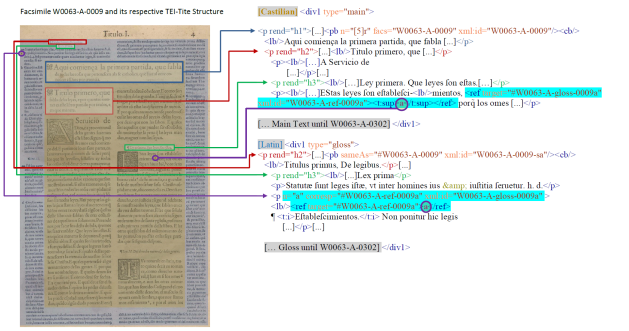

Figure 1. López/de Castilla: Primera Partida , page 4, see: catalogue and facsimile view of this work

Related work

Digital resources related to the 1555 edition focus mainly on the original text in Castilian. For example, the critical and digital edition 7 Partidas Digital Project . Similarly, the Boletín Oficial del Estado (BOE) has published a facsimile edition with a standard text search, recognized as the authentic text by the Royal Decree of 1555. Our contribution offers the scholarly community an academic source presented in a text-image reading view with diplomatic full-text search of both the original text in Castilian and the Latin glosses that comment on it. It also includes, cross-referencing between both texts.

Project's Workflow

The project has focused on creating a sustainable and scalable workflow for editing large volumes of text, emphasizing the reusability of tools, thorough documentation, and traceability to support future research.

Step 1: Facsimiles

It starts with the digitization of the printed originals according to the specifications of the DFG-Praxisregeln Digitalisierung . The facsimiles are checked for completeness and scanning errors; the bibliographic metadata of the original print are collected to ensure compliance with international RDA standards ; the facsimiles are then published on the project's website viewer under open access conditions using IIIF .

Step 2: TEI-Transcription

External providers initially capture the full-text into TEI-Tite following our project's general transcription instructions and work-specific transcription instructions (only in German) Upon delivery, we transform and enrich the text in TEI-All

according to our edition guidelines (only in German). Consequently, we developed specific transcription instructions for *Las Siete Partidas* to ensure both the main text (Castilian), and the marginal area (Latin glosses) are transcribed into separate divisions <**div**> , linked bidirectionally using <**ref target**> and <**div xml:id**> . TEI-specific markup will be shown in the poster.

Step 3: The School of Salamanca Website

The website presents the text and image in a linked reading view, utilizing the data generated in Steps 1 and 2 to enable cross-referencing between the Castilian text and Latin glosses. The source code of our web application is available in an external GitHub repository .

Conclusion

Currently, our project invests substantial time and resources to complete the edition of this work and provide a user-friendly resource for the academic community. This work also serves as a model for future editions of similarly structured texts within our collection, such as Pérez de Salamanca (1575), (1574).

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